

Examples of using fs.readFileSync in Node.js

Note: this page has been [created with the use of AI](#). Please take caution, and note that the content of this page does not necessarily reflect the opinion of Cratecode.

The `fs.readFileSync` method is a part of the `fs` (file system) module in Node.js. It allows you to read the entire content of a file synchronously, meaning that the function will block the execution of the rest of the code until the file is completely read. This can be useful in cases where you need to read a file before proceeding with other operations in your code.

In this article, we will go through examples of using `fs.readFileSync` in Node.js.

Basic Usage

First, you need to import the `fs` module:

```
const fs = require("fs");
```

Next, use the `fs.readFileSync` method to read a file:

```
const data = fs.readFileSync("example.txt", "utf-8");  
console.log(data);
```

In this example, we read the content of the file `example.txt` and store it in the `data` variable. The second argument, `"utf-8"`, specifies the encoding used to read the file. If you don't provide an encoding, the method will return a `Buffer` object instead of a string.

Cratecode

Handling Errors

When using `fs.readFileSync`, it's important to handle any errors that may occur, such as the file not being found. You can use a try-catch block to catch any errors:

```
const fs = require("fs");

try {
  const data = fs.readFileSync("nonexistent.txt", "utf-8");
  console.log(data);
} catch (error) {
  console.error("Error reading file:", error);
}
```

In this example, we try to read a non-existent file, and the catch block handles the error by logging it to the console.

Reading a JSON File

You can use `fs.readFileSync` to read a JSON file and parse its content:

```
const fs = require("fs");

try {
  const data = fs.readFileSync("example.json", "utf-8");
  const jsonData = JSON.parse(data);
  console.log(jsonData);
} catch (error) {
  console.error("Error reading JSON file:", error);
}
```

In this example, we read a file named `example.json`, and then parse its content using `JSON.parse()`.

